

commencement” (“My End Is My Beginning”), c. 1370



GUILLAUME DE MACHAUT, FRANCE, 14TH CENTURY

John Dunstaple

c. 1390–1453, ENGLISH

Little is known about Dunstaple's life, but in his own time he was recognized as a major figure, and he is now acknowledged as the outstanding English composer of the 15th century. (He is also said to have been skilled in astronomy and mathematics.) There is evidence that he worked for several high-ranking patrons, notably John of Lancaster, Duke of Bedford (Henry V's brother), but the